

What you are learning: Persuasive writing makes the reader agree with you. You do this with techniques (AFOREST), a clear point, and writing that is aimed at your reader.

Techniques toolkit — AFOREST (key words)

A Alliteration	words near each other start with the same sound <i>e.g. bold, brave and brilliant</i>
F Facts	true information that is hard to argue with <i>e.g. Exercise is good for your heart.</i>
O Opinion	what you believe, said with confidence <i>e.g. This is the best choice for everyone.</i>
R Rhetorical question	a question that makes the reader think (no answer needed) <i>e.g. Is that really fair?</i>
E Emotive language	words that make the reader feel something <i>e.g. Imagine losing everything you love.</i>
S Statistics	believable numbers that back you up <i>e.g. Over half of students agree.</i>
T Triplet (rule of three)	three points in a row for power <i>e.g. We are tired, rushed and ignored.</i>

Model paragraph — longer lunch break

Picture this: it is 1:15 and you have just five minutes left to eat. Is that really fair? A longer lunch would give us time to eat, move and reset. Over half of students say they feel rushed. We are tired, we are hungry, and we deserve better.

Opening hook

Rhetorical question

Triplet

Statistic

Emotive ending

Common mistakes

- Naming a technique instead of using it. Don't write 'I will use emotive language' — show it: 'Imagine losing everything you love.'
- Making up silly statistics. Keep them believable, e.g. 'Over half of students...' not '100% of everyone ever.'
- One giant paragraph. Use short paragraphs — one point each.
- Forgetting your reader. Match your tone to the audience (a head teacher is different from a friend).

Writing checklist

- Before: Who is my reader? What is my one main point?
- As I write: Start with a hook. One point per paragraph. Use 2–3 techniques.
- Check: Does every line push my argument? Have I ended strongly?

Your turn — tasks get harder as you go

1. Spot it

Name the technique: 'We must act now, now, now!'

2. Improve it

Rewrite using emotive language: 'The park is closing.'

3. Write it

Write 2–3 persuasive sentences for a longer lunch break. Use at least two techniques and underline them.
